YOUR JUDO JOURNEY · NETHERLANDS

Start at your club.
Dream of the Olympics.

Meet new opponents. Try your techniques. Grow one step at a time.

FIRST MATCHES → NATIONAL COMPETITIONS

1 First competitions
Have fun and learn how matches work.
- Club championships
- Cross-club matches
- **Ontwikkelingstoernooien**
- Instap / opstap

2 Local & regional
Meet more judoka from other clubs.
- **Klompentoernooi** — Regional B groups · U9 / U11
- West-Friese Jeugd Judo Competitie
- Afdelingskampioenschappen

3 District & bigger opens
Try a bigger field of opponents.
- DK · district championships
- Flevoland Open
- Shizentai Open

4 Strong international opens
Take on experienced international judoka.
- **Venray**
- Glaspalast · Sindelfingen — **Germany · U15 and older**
- Elefanten-Cup · Norderstedt — **Germany · U9 / U11 / U13 and older**

5 NK & top youth opens
Dutch titles and strong international fields.
- NK · U15 / U18 / U21 / seniors
- **Dutch Open Espoir · U15 / U18 / U21** — Can be tougher than youth NK

DK → qualify → NK for U15 / U18. You can take this route without doing Level 4.

INTERNATIONAL YOUTH → SENIOR WORLD STAGE

6 European Cups
Test yourself on the European youth circuit.
- Cadets · U18
- Juniors · U21

7 Youth EK & WK
Represent the Netherlands at a championship.
- European championships
- World championships
- U18 / U21 · national selection

8 Senior international circuit
Build towards the World Judo Tour.
- Senior Cups → Continental Opens
- Grand Prix → Grand Slams

9 Senior EK & WK
Compete for European and world titles.
- European championships
- World championships
- National selection

10 Olympic Games
The Olympic mat.
- Olympic qualification + selection

Levels overlap. Your age group and opponents change the challenge.

Pick your next step with your coach.

U13 = under 13 · **DK** = district · **NK** = Dutch · **EK** = European · **WK** = world

Individual judo · Illustrative competition levels

Sources checked September 2026